edge to developing judgement.

I would also add that a common response to AI in management education today is simply to add a course—'AI for managers' or 'AI for marketing'. I do not believe that is how AI will transform management education. The shift needs to be more fundamental: shifting the domain entirely towards problem-solving, with AI as an enabling technology that provides more knowledge and helps solve the problem as a whole, rather than producing merely "AI-aware" managers through add-on courses. Institutions need this fundamental shift in management education for it to remain relevant, otherwise managers and AI-technology heads will end up competing for the same leadership positions, with equal opportunity to win them.

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Our survey reveals that among the top 25 business schools, the student mix has changed. The number of engineering graduates has fallen while non-engineers have risen. What kind of results is this shift delivering?

I will answer this in two parts: IIM Ahmedabad, and the rest of management education in India. We have always focused on a class mix that was not dominated by any single sector. Historically, our mix has been around 60% engineers and at least 40% from commerce, chartered accountancy, law, medicine, and other professions. Solutions and thinking improve when case discussions include people from varied backgrounds.

In our case, the shift has been modest. Last year, we had around 50% non-engineers—an increase of 10 to 12 percentage points. Today, chartered accountants increasingly say that an MBA would have made them better off, and so they are competing for the same seats. That is one natural factor driving the shift.

The second factor is that other management institutes have recognised that IIM Ahmedabad's classroom mix is central to why it continues to produce more corporate leaders than most, and many are now adopting their own diversity mechanisms to bring in more non-engineers. This process began roughly 10 to 15 years ago, around 2010, and its results are increasingly visible.

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Indian B-schools have produced globally successful leaders and CEOs. But beyond leadership talent, how are they contributing to global management thinking through original research and thought leadership? What more ideas are needed for Indian B-schools to have a stronger global influence?

This is a very apt question. For the first 40 years, Indian management education focused on creating and grooming managers to solve local, Indian industry problems, but without documenting that work to the extent Western schools have documented and built frameworks.

Only about 20 years ago did Indian management schools take this turn, recognising a responsibility to also contribute to and document their work, rather than remain followers who simply learned from others' frameworks. This is what we today call research and publishing, and it was really seeded only around 20 years ago. We are beginning to see the impact: frameworks emerging from Indian research are increasingly being used within India, even if the Western world has not readily adopted them yet.

I believe that if we stay on this path, it will take another 15-20 years for the world to begin recognising this work more widely, as our economy grows and our solutions are adopted globally rather than the reverse. It is not that Indian management schools are not doing the research, our priorities were not aligned with documentation and publication. We started this documentation process quite late and are now working on it, and within another decade, we should begin to see Indian management thinking penetrating and being adopted globally. BT

"MBA education must shift from being about acquiring knowledge to developing judgement"

@szarabi

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